

トリックテイカーズ

TRICKTAKERS



COMPONENTS



*Additional variant components listed on page 34

8 Character Cards



8 Mini Character Cards for 2 Players



40 Playing Cards



2 Rare Cards



5 Suit Hierarchy Cards



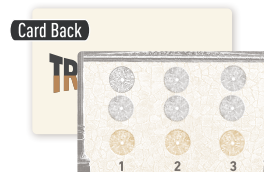
6 Game Aid Cards



7 Berserker Cards



6 Ruler Task Cards



1 Round Card



5 Gold Crowns



6 Black Crowns



1 King 'Rare' Card



2 Adventurer Cards



15 Adventurer Item Cards



1 Gambler 'Bidding' Token



1 Resistance 'Revolt' Token
1 Collector 'Reserve' Token



4 Ruler 'Lead' Tokens



20 Point Tokens (10pts)



20 Point Tokens (50pts)



1 Lead Player Token

■ GAME OVERVIEW

トリックテイカーズ TRICKTAKERS

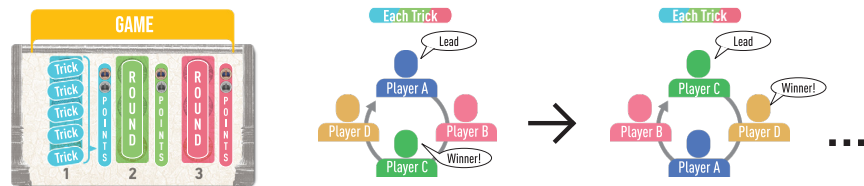
Every decade a tournament is held to decide who will be the next greatest Tricktaker. To prepare for this tournament, contenders spend years developing their own unique set of skills.

As the final battle approaches, these eight are all that remain...



Players will be signing “contracts” with one of the eight characters each round in order to gain the upper hand in winning the most tricks... or possibly wanting no tricks at all. Using their character’s abilities, players will be able to draw new cards during the round, change the hierarchy of suit strength, use items to manipulate their cards, gain access to the highest cards in each suit, and more!

A game of TRICKTAKERS typically consists of 3 rounds. In each round, players will select a character that they will use for the round after they are dealt 5 cards. Players will then play 5 tricks, in clockwise order. After 5 tricks, players will gain crowns and/or score points according to their characters. After 3 rounds, the player with the highest score wins. However, this is not always the case since there are three other ways to win the game!



4

WINNING CONDITIONS

1 Fulfill A Character's Win Condition

Each character has their own winning condition. After fulfilling the condition, that player wins the game.

5 tricks **Win the game**

9 Straight Flush **Win the game**

4 bid **Win the game**
5 tricks **Win the game**

Any Black card **Win the game**

2 Have 2 Gold Crowns

The player who wins the most tricks in a round gains a gold crown. After gaining 2 gold crowns, that player wins the game.



3 Have 3 Black Crowns

A player who wins no tricks in a round gains a black crown. After gaining 3 black crowns, that player wins the game.



4 Have The Most Points

If no player has fulfilled 1, 2, or 3 after 3 rounds, the player with the most points wins the game.



■ If multiple winning conditions are met in the same round, the earlier condition wins (1 > 2 > 3 > 4).

■ If multiple players accomplish the same winning condition at the same time, the player who has the higher priority character wins.

Example: In Round 3, the King wins 5 tricks and the Berserker wins 0 tricks. This triggers Winning Condition 1 for both characters. However, the King wins the game because they have the higher priority.

Character Priority



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■ HOW TO PLAY: UNDERSTANDING A TRICK AND DECK MAKEUP

A “trick” refers to all players, in clockwise order, taking turns playing one card from their hand to the middle of the table. When starting a new trick, the first person to play a card is known as the “lead player.” The lead player may play any one card from their hand. All other players “must follow” suit, i.e., play one card of the same color as the lead player, if possible. If a player cannot follow suit, they may play any card, known as “playing off suit.” After all cards are played, the person who played the card with the highest strength wins the trick. If two or more cards with the same strength are played in a trick, the first one played wins.

The winner of the trick collects all of the played cards, puts them in a face down pile in front of themselves, and then becomes the lead player for the next trick.

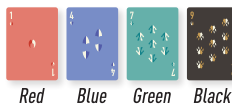


When winning multiple tricks, be sure to keep each trick pile separate. This will make it easier to count the number of tricks you have won!

There are 40 cards in the deck, which consists of Number cards, Rare cards, and White Flag cards.

• 36 Number Cards

4 colored suits, numbered 1 to 9

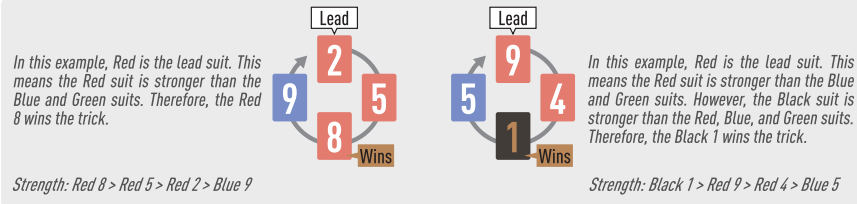


Card Strength

When determining the winner of the trick, you need to compare the strength of each card played. When comparing Number Cards, normally, the larger the number, the stronger the card (e.g. Blue 9 > Blue 5 > Blue 1).

However, when comparing the Red, Blue, and Green suits, the lead suit is considered to be stronger than the other two. Additionally, the Black suit is the trump suit, meaning it is stronger than the Red, Blue, and Green suits.

Note: The Black (trump) suit can be lead at any time and does not need to be “broken,” meaning played off suit, first.



Must Follow

When a player has a card in hand that matches the color of the lead suit, they must play it. If they have 2 or more cards of the same color, they can choose which card to play. If they don't have any cards in hand that match the lead suit, they can play any card from hand.



The lead player plays a Red 5. If this was your hand, the Red 2 or Red 7 must be played, but you can choose which one to play.



The lead player plays a Red 5. If this was your hand, you would be able to play any card since you do not have a Red card in hand.

• 2 Rare Cards



The Rare cards are stronger than all Number cards. A Rare card can be played at any time during a player's turn, allowing them to ignore the must follow rules.

• 2 White Flag Cards



The White Flag cards are weaker than all Number cards. A White Flag card can be played at any time during a player's turn, allowing them to ignore the must follow rules.



The lead player plays a Red 5. If this was your hand, you would have to play the Red 4 to satisfy the must follow rule. However, you could play the Rare or White Flag card instead, since they can be played at any time.

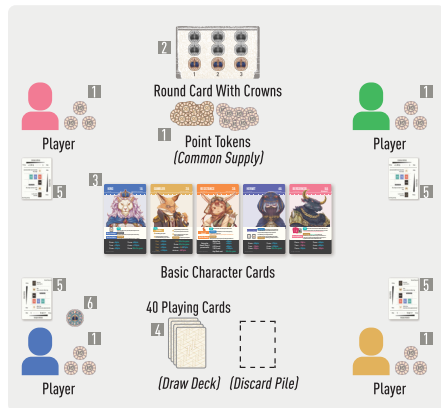


Note: The Rare and White Flag cards are colorless. If they are lead, the next non-Rare or non-White Flag card played will determine the lead suit.

■ HOW TO PLAY: GAME PREPARATION (3-5 PLAYERS)



The following rules are used when playing with 3-5 players. The 2-player rules are explained on pages 28-31.



For your first few games, it is recommended to keep the 6 Game Aid cards nearby. These cards help outline the steps for Game Preparation, Round 1 gameplay, Round 2 gameplay, Round 3 gameplay, the character selection process for each round, the order of character priority, and the various winning conditions.

1 Give each player 30 points. Place the remaining point tokens near the middle of the table, creating the common supply.

2 Place the round card near the middle of the table and put the 3 gold crowns and 6 black crowns on top of the round card.

3 Place the 5 basic character (King, Gambler, Resistance, Hermit, and Berserker) cards face up near the middle of the table.

For your first few games, it is recommended to use these 5 basic characters. After you are comfortable with the basic characters, you may add the 3 advanced characters (explained in more detail on pages 22-27).

4 Shuffle all 40 playing cards and place them face down near the character cards, creating the draw deck. Leave room next to the draw deck for a discard pile.

Note: Cards can be discarded by character abilities throughout the round. If the draw deck is ever empty, immediately shuffle all cards in the discard pile, face down, and create a new draw deck.

5 Give each player 1 Suit Hierarchy card, with the white border side face up.

6 Choose a lead player and give them the lead player token.

The last person to win a game of TRICKTAKERS will be the lead player, otherwise choose randomly.

■ HOW TO PLAY: ROUND 1 (3-5 PLAYERS)



1 Deal Playing Cards

Deal 5 cards to each player from the draw deck. Players should look at the cards that are dealt to them, but make sure to keep them hidden from the other players.

2 Select a Character

Starting from the lead player and going clockwise, each player selects a face up character card from the middle of the table and places it face up in front of themselves. Any unselected characters should be set aside for now.

3 Set Up Characters

Setting up each character is completed in character priority order, highest first (1A, 2A, 3A...). However, to help speed up the process, players may agree to do this step simultaneously. Each character is explained in more detail on pages 12-27.

4 Play Tricks and Check For A Character's Win Condition

Play 5 tricks as described on pages 6-7. Then, check to see if **any player has fulfilled their character's win condition. If so, that player wins immediately!** If no character's win condition has been met, proceed to steps **5A** - **8**.

Note: Keep in mind the Resistance (3A) character can fulfill their win condition during the round!

Reminder: If multiple players have accomplished their character's win condition, the winner is determined by the higher character priority.

5 Gain Gold Crown



The player who won the most tricks in the round will gain a gold crown. **If there is a tie for the most tricks, no one gets the gold crown for that round and it is returned to the box instead.**

6 Gain Black Crown



Any player that won zero tricks in the round will be eligible to gain a black crown. **Only 2 players can gain a black crown. If there are 3 or more eligible players to gain a black crown, players will gain them in higher character priority order.** Any leftover black crowns should be returned to the box (this will happen if 0 players or only 1 player gains a black crown).

7 Gain Points and Gain Lead Player Token



All players will gain (or lose) points according to the conditions written on their character card. Give the lead player token to the player with the least amount of points and no gold crown. If there is a tie for points, the player with the higher character priority takes the token. **This player will get to choose who leads the first trick in the next round.**

Note: Players cannot have less than 0 points. If you were to lose points and go below 0, stop at 0 points instead.

8 Check For A Crown Victory

After crowns and points are handed out, check to see if **any player has 2 gold crowns or 3 black crowns. If so, that player wins immediately!** If no player has 2 gold crowns or 3 black crowns, proceed to the next round.

Note: This can happen in Round 1 when using some of the promo or expansion characters!

■ HOW TO PLAY: ROUND 2 (3-5 PLAYERS)



1 Deal Playing Cards

Gather all 40 playing cards, shuffle them, and place them in the middle of the table creating a new draw deck. Deal 5 cards to each player.

2 Select a Character

All players will return the character they used in the previous round to the middle of the table, along with the unselected characters that were set aside earlier. Next, players will select a new character for this round in the order specified below. Players may select the same character they selected in the previous round, except for the King.

Players will select characters in the following order:

👑 The player who selected the King in the previous round. **They cannot select the King again this round.**

👑 The players who **do not** have a gold crown, starting with the player who has the lowest number of points. If there is a tie, the player who selected a character from the previous round with a higher priority will go first.

Example: Players A, B, and C do not have gold crowns. Player B has 30 points, while Players A and C are tied with 80 points each. Player B will select a character first. Then, Players A and C need to compare their character priority from the previous round. Player A was the Gambler (2A) and Player C was the Hermit (4A). Therefore, Player A will select a character before Player C.

👑 The players who have a gold crown, starting with the player who has the lowest number of points. If there is a tie, the player who selected a character from the previous round with a higher priority will go first.

Note: Black crowns are not taken into consideration during the selection process stated above. Only gold crowns are taken into consideration.

3 Set Up Characters

Set up each character as described in Round 1.

4 Play Tricks and Check For A Character's Win Condition

Play tricks and check for a character's win condition as described in Round 1, with one difference: Whoever has the lead player token will choose the lead player for the first trick, which can include themselves.

5 Gain Gold Crown, Gain Black Crown, Gain Points, and Gain Lead Player Token



Players will gain crowns, points, and the lead player token as described in Round 1.

Reminder: The player who won the most tricks in the round (no ties) will gain the gold crown. Only 2 players who won 0 tricks in the round will gain a black crown (ties are broken by higher character priority). All players will gain or lose points based on their character.

6 Check For A Crown Victory

After players gain crowns and points, check for a crown victory as described in Round 1.

■ HOW TO PLAY: ROUND 3 (3-5 PLAYERS)



1 Deal Playing Cards

Deal out the playing cards as described in Round 2.

2 Select a Character

Select a character as described in Round 2.

3 Set Up Characters and Spend Black Crowns



Set up each character as described in Round 1, with one difference: While you are setting up your character, if you have a black crown, you **may** return it to the game box to discard any number of cards from your hand, face down, and draw that many back from the draw deck. If you have a second black crown, you may do it again.

4 Play Tricks and Check For A Character's Win Condition

Play tricks and check for a character's win condition as described in Round 2.

5 Gain Gold Crown, Gain Black Crown, and Gain Points



Players will gain crowns and points as described in Round 1, with one difference: Each basic character has a "Round 3" ability that may change the way they gain points.

Reminder: The player who won the most tricks in the round (no ties) will gain the gold crown. Only 2 players who won 0 tricks in the round will gain a black crown (ties are broken by higher character priority). All players will gain or lose points based on their character.

6 Check For A Crown Victory

After players gain crowns and points, check for a crown victory as described in Round 1. If no player has won, then proceed to step 7.

7 Calculate Points and Determine Final Winner

All players will calculate the number of points they have and the player with the most points wins! If there is a tie, the player with the higher priority character wins.

The next few pages will explain the unique abilities of each character. Many of these abilities will break the normal rules of the game, so it is very important to remember:

If a character text or ability directly contradicts any text from the rulebook so far, the text or ability of the character takes precedence!

HOW TO PLAY: BASIC CHARACTERS - KING

EASY



Card Back

King Rare Card

During 'Step 3: Set Up Characters,' you **must** add the King Rare card to your hand and discard any other card of your choice.

Reminder: All discarded cards are placed face down in a separate discard pile near the draw deck.



You select the King and take the King Rare card into your hand ① and then choose to discard the Blue 8 ②.

King's Privilege

Next round, regardless of any gold crown or number of points that you have, you will select a character first during 'Step 2 Select a Character.' However, you must select a different character, as you cannot be the King two rounds in a row.

The Final Battle

In Round 3, you will gain twice as many points as shown on the character card.

King's Privilege	
0 tricks = 0pts	3 tricks = 80pts
1 trick = 10pts	4 tricks = 120pts
2 tricks = 50pts	5 tricks = Win the game

Example: As the King, you won 2 tricks in Round 3. So, you would gain 100 points instead of 50 points.

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HOW TO PLAY: BASIC CHARACTERS - GAMBLER

MODERATE



Gamble

During 'Step 3: Set Up Characters,' complete the following 4 steps in this exact order:

- 1 Immediately gain 20 points
- 2 You **may** discard any number of cards from your hand and draw that many back from the draw deck. You **may** do this a second time.
Note: Every part of this step is optional. This means you may discard and draw 0, 1, or 2 times.
Reminder: All discarded cards are placed face down in a separate discard pile near the draw deck.
- 3 Using the Bidding Card and Token, you **must** bid on how many tricks you think you will win during the round.
If you win 5 tricks during the round, you automatically win the game, so there is no need to bid for 5 tricks. The "5 bid" shown on the card is only used for 2-player games.
- 4 Using up to 50 of your points, you **may** make a bet that you will hit your bid. In Round 3, you may bet up to 100 of your points! At the end of the round, if you hit your bid (won the same number of tricks as shown on your Bidding Card) then you will gain points from the common supply equal to the number of points you bet. Additionally, you will gain back the points you bet with. However, if you miss your bid you will lose those points.

Note: The points you used in your bet are placed near the Bidding Card, keeping them separate from the rest of your points in your personal supply. This separation becomes more important with some of the expansion characters.



You select the Gambler and immediately gain 20 points ①. Next, you choose to discard 3 cards from your hand (Red 3, Green 2, and Green 6) and draw 3 cards back from the draw deck (Red 9, White Flag, and Black 1) ②. You are happy with your new hand and choose not to discard and draw a second time ③. Next, you make a bid of 2 ④. Finally, you bet 50 of your points by placing them next to the Bidding Card ⑤.

Example Scoring 1: You bid 2 tricks and bet 50 points. During the round, you won 2 tricks.

You will gain 190 points. +90 points from your character card for the successful bid of 2 tricks +50 points from the common supply for your successful bet = 140 points. Additionally, the 50 points you used for the successful bet will be returned to you. 140 + 50 = 190 points.

Example Scoring 2: You bid 2 tricks and bet 50 points. During the round, you won 3 tricks.

You will lose 50 points. ±0 points from your character card since you missed your bid of 2 tricks = 0 points. Additionally, the 50 points you used for the unsuccessful bet are lost (return them to the common supply) 0-50 = -50 points from your total score.

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■ HOW TO PLAY: BASIC CHARACTERS - RESISTANCE

MODERATE



Revolt

During 'Step 3: Set Up Characters,' place the Revolt Token next to your character card. Once per round, on your turn during 'Step 4: Play Tricks,' you may place the Revolt Token on the card you just played. By doing so, the card strength hierarchy is reversed for this trick (the lowest strength card wins instead of the highest strength). This trick is known as the 'Revolt Trick.' After the Revolt Trick is over, set the Revolt Token aside. It cannot be used again this round. During the Revolt Trick keep these four things in mind:

- The lead suit advantage between the Red, Blue, and Green suits is nullified. Normally, if Blue was the lead suit, Blue is stronger than Red and Green, regardless of the number. However, during the Revolt Trick, the suits become equal strength and it comes down to the lowest number played. **You still must follow suit when playing!**

Note: Also keep in mind the Black suit is a higher strength and will lose to the Red, Blue, and Green suits during a Revolt trick.

- The effect of the Hermit's White Flag being stronger than a Rare card (explained on page 16) is nullified. The effect of the 1s being stronger than the Berserker's 10s or the Berserker card (explained on page 17) is nullified. *Simply put, during the Revolt Trick, there are no card strengthening abilities and the weakest (or lowest strength) card wins.*

- If there is a tie for the lowest strength card in the Revolt Trick, the first one played wins as normal.

- If you win the Revolt Trick, depending on the card you win with, you will score a varying amount of points.

Win with

White Flag	Points
Red/Blue/Green 1, 2, or 3	30 points
Red/Blue/Green 4, 5, or 6	50 points
Red/Blue/Green 7, 8, or 9	80 points
Any Black Card	100 points

Points

White Flag	Points
Red/Blue/Green 1, 2, or 3	30 points
Red/Blue/Green 4, 5, or 6	50 points
Red/Blue/Green 7, 8, or 9	80 points
Any Black Card	100 points

Win the game!



See page 19 for more Revolt Trick examples.



Strength: Blue 1 = Green 1 > Red 2 > Red 3 > Black 1



Strength: Red 1 > Red 7 > Black 1 > Rare > Berserker



Strength: WF = WF > Blue 1 > Blue 9 > Berserker

Example 1: The lead suit is Red, however, the lead suit advantage is nullified during the Revolt Trick. Therefore, the Blue 1 and Green 1 are tied for being the lowest strength card. The Blue 1 wins the trick because it was the first one played.

Example 2: The lead suit is Red, however, the lead suit advantage is nullified during the Revolt Trick. Additionally, the effect of 1s being stronger than the Berserker is nullified. The Red 1 is a lower strength card than the Black 1, so it wins the trick.

Example 3: The lead suit is Blue, however, the lead suit advantage is nullified during the Revolt Trick. Additionally, the effect of 1s being stronger than the Berserker is nullified. The White Flag is the lowest strength card and two of them were played, so the first one played wins the trick.

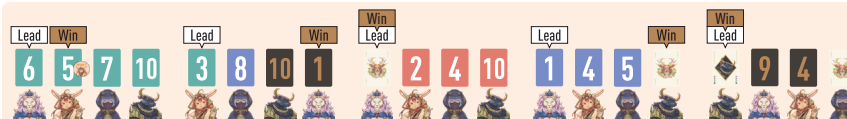
■ HOW TO PLAY: BASIC CHARACTERS - RESISTANCE



Black Crown

If you manage to only win 1 trick during the round, and it was the Revolt Trick, you will still be eligible to gain a black crown. However, if you win any non-Revolt trick during the round, you will not be eligible for a black crown.

Note: You will still eligible to gain a black crown if you win 0 tricks in the round as normal.



Trick 1

Trick 2

Trick 3

Trick 4

Trick 5

As the Resistance, you won 1 trick this round and it was the Revolt Trick. So, you are eligible for a black crown this round.



Trick 1

Trick 2

Trick 3

Trick 4

Trick 5

As the Resistance, you won 1 trick this round and it was not the Revolt Trick. So, you are not eligible for a black crown this round.

Battle Ready

In Round 3, you will gain 30 points for each trick you win, including the Revolt Trick.



Example: As the Resistance you won 3 tricks in Round 3, which includes winning a trick with a White Flag during the Revolt Trick, so you would gain 120 points: 30 points for winning the Revolt trick with a White Flag and 90 points for winning 3 tricks.

HOW TO PLAY: BASIC CHARACTERS - HERMIT

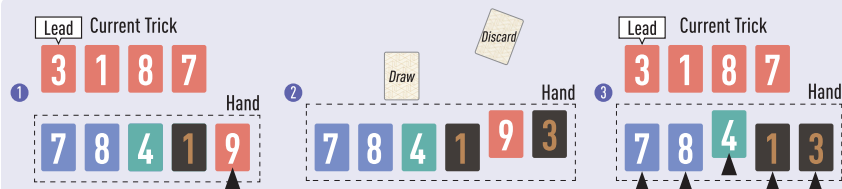
EASY



Dexterous Hand

On your turn, during 'Step 4: Play Tricks,' before you play a card, you may draw 1 card from the draw deck and then discard any 1 card from your hand, including the card you just drew.

Reminder: All discarded cards are placed face down in a separate discard pile near the draw deck.



Red is the lead suit, so normally you would have to play the Red 9 ¹. However, at the start of your turn, you draw a card from the draw deck (the Black 3) and then you discard 1 card (the Red 9) ². You no longer have a Red card in your hand, so you may play any card into the trick. You choose to play the Green 4 to make sure you lose the trick ³. You could have played the Black 1 or Black 3 to win the trick instead.

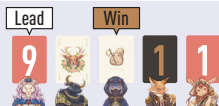
White Flag > Rare

When played by the Hermit, their White Flag card becomes stronger than the Rare card. However, if there are no Rare cards in the trick, the White Flag keeps its original strength. Each time you win a trick this way, regardless of how many Rare cards are in the trick, you will immediately gain 100 points. In Round 3, you will gain 100 points instead.

Another way of looking at it would be to say the Hermit's White Flag becomes a Rare+1 for that trick.

Note: This ability only applies to the Hermit's White Flag, no other character.

Reminder: This ability is nullified during the Revolt Trick.



Example 1: The Rare card would normally be the strongest card and win the trick. However, the Hermit played a White Flag, so it becomes stronger than the Rare and wins the trick.

Strength: WF > Rare > Black 1 > Red 9 > Red 1



Example 2: The Rare card would normally be the strongest card and win the trick. However, the Hermit played a White Flag, so it becomes stronger than the Rare and wins the trick. Additionally, the King's White Flag keeps its normal strength.

Strength: WF (Hermit) > Rare > Blue 8 > Blue 3 > WF (King)

HOW TO PLAY: BASIC CHARACTERS - BERSERKER

MODERATE



Berserker Deck

During 'Step 3: Set Up Characters,' you must discard all 5 cards from your hand. Then, add the Berserker card and shuffle 4 other random cards from the Berserker Deck into your hand. Keep the 2 unselected cards from the Berserker Deck nearby, face down.

Reminder: All discarded cards are placed face down in a separate discard pile near the draw deck.

The Berserker Deck consists of:



Note: The Berserker card is colorless and can be played at any time, ignoring the must follow rules. If it is lead, the next non-Rare or non-White Flag card played will determine the lead suit.



You select the Berserker and immediately discard all 5 cards from your hand (Blue 1, Blue 2, Green 3, Red 1, and White Flag) ¹. Next, you put the Berserker card into your hand and shuffle the 6 remaining cards from the Berserker Deck ². You draw 4 random cards into your hand (Blue 10, Green 10, Black 10, and Rare) ³. Finally, you leave the 2 unselected cards (Red 10 and White Flag) face down nearby ⁴.

- A '1' is stronger than the '10' of the matching suit (Red 1 is stronger than the Red 10).
Another way of looking at it would be to say the Red 1 becomes the Red 11 for that trick.
- A '1' is not stronger than the '10' of a non-matching suit (Red 1 is not stronger than the Blue, Green, or Black 10).
- The Berserker card is normally the strongest card in the game, stronger than a Rare. However, the Red 1, Blue 1, Green 1, and Black 1 are all stronger than the Berserker card. If multiple 1s are played in the same trick as the Berserker card, they are all considered to be the same strength, regardless of color, so the first one played wins.

Another way of looking at it would be to say the Red 1, Blue 1, Green 1, and Black 1 become a Berserker+1 for that trick.

Reminder: These abilities are nullified during the Revolt Trick.

HOW TO PLAY: BASIC CHARACTERS - BERSERKER



Strength: Red 1 > Red 10 > Red 9 > Blue 1 = Green 1



Strength: Red 9 > Red 1 > Blue 1 > Blue 10 > Green 1



Strength: Berserker > WF > Rare > Black 9 > Red 9



Strength: Red 1 = Black 1 = Blue 1 > Berserker > Rare



Strength: Black 4 > Red 1 > Red 10 > Red 5 > Green 1

Example 1: The Red 1 is stronger than the Red 10 and Red is the lead suit. The Blue 1 and Green 1 do not match the Red 10's suit, so they are not stronger than the Red 10. So, the Red 1 is the strongest card in the trick and wins.

Example 2: The Blue 1 is stronger than the Blue 10. However, the lead suit is Red, which means Red is stronger than Blue and Green. So, the Red 9 is the strongest card in the trick and wins.

Example 3: The Hermit played a White Flag which is stronger than the Rare, but not stronger than the Berserker. The Berserker card is always the strongest card unless there is a '1' of any suit in the trick. There are no 1s, so the Berserker card wins the trick.

Example 4: The Black 1 is normally stronger than the Red 1. However, all 1s are stronger than the Berserker, regardless of color. This means the Red 1, Black 1, and Blue 1 are equal strength. The Red 1 was played first, so it wins the trick.

Example 5: The Red 1 is stronger than the Red 10. However, the Black 4 is stronger than the Red 1 since the Black suit is stronger than the Red Suit. So the Black 4 wins the trick.

Fierce Uplifting In Round 3, you will win the game if you win 0 tricks.

In Round 3, during 'Step 3: Set Up Characters and Spend Black Crowns', you may spend a black crown, after getting your 5 card hand from the Berserker Deck. When discarding, you cannot discard the Berserker Card and you can only discard up to 2 cards. When drawing, you can only draw from the 2 unselected cards from the Berserker Deck instead of the draw deck.



HOW TO PLAY: TRICK WINNER EXAMPLES

Normal Tricks

Highest Strength Wins



Strength: Black 1 > Black 10 > Black 9 > Red 9



Strength: Black 4 > Red 1 > Red 10 > Red 6



Strength: Rare = Rare (King) = Rare > Black 2
First Rare played wins



Strength: WF (Hermit) > Rare > Green 3 > WF



Strength: Black 7 > Red 7 > Green 7 = Blue 7



Strength: Black 1 > Berserker > Green 8 > Blue 4

Revolt Tricks

Lowest Strength Wins



Strength: Red 9 > Black 1 > Black 9 > Black 10
1s being higher strength than 10s is nullified



Strength: Red 1 > Red 6 > Red 10 > Black 4
1s being higher strength than 10s is nullified

Wins the game!



Strength: Black 2 > Rare = Rare (King) = Rare
Resistance satisfies their win condition



Strength: WF (Resist.) = WF (Hermit) > Green 3 > Rare
Hermit WF being higher strength than Rare is nullified



Strength: Red 7 = Green 7 = Blue 7 > Black 7



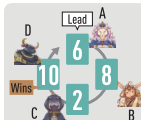
Strength: Blue 4 > Green 8 > Black 1 > Berserker
1s being higher strength than Berserker is nullified

■ HOW TO PLAY: ROUND 1 GAMEPLAY EXAMPLE - 4 PLAYERS



■ Players are ready to begin a game of TRICKTAKERS and need to select their characters. Player A selects the King, Player B the Resistance, Player C the Hermit, and Player D the Berserker. The Gambler was not selected and is set aside for the round.

■ The King requires Player A to take the King Rare card into their hand and discard any other card. The Resistance requires Player B to place the 'Revolt' token next to their character card. The Berserker requires Player D to discard their entire hand and take the Berserker card into their hand. Next, they shuffle the rest of the Berserker Deck and draw 4 random cards into their hand, setting the other 2 aside, face down. After this, players are ready to begin trick play.



Trick 1

Trick 1: Player A (King) plays Green 6, therefore, Green is the lead suit. Player B (Resistance) plays Green 8, Player C (Hermit) draws one card from the deck, discards one card, and then plays Green 2, and Player D (Berserker) plays Green 10. Player D (Berserker) played the highest strength card, so they win the trick and will lead the next trick.

Player A: 0 tricks

Player B: 0 tricks

Player C: 0 tricks

Player D: 1 trick



Trick 2

Trick 2: Player D (Berserker) plays Blue 10, therefore, Blue is the lead suit. Player A (King) does not have any Blue cards and plays Black 9, Player B (Resistance) plays Blue 5, and Player C (Hermit) draws one card from the deck, discards one card, and then plays Blue 3. Player A (King) played the highest strength card, because Black (as trump) is stronger than Blue, so they win the trick and will lead the next trick.

Player A: 1 trick

Player B: 0 tricks

Player C: 0 tricks

Player D: 1 trick



Trick 3

Trick 3: Player A (King) plays their King Rare card. Because a Rare card was lead, no lead suit has been determined yet and Player B can play any card they want. Player B (Resistance) plays Black 1, therefore, Black is the lead suit. Player B also places the 'Revolt' token on their card to trigger the Revolt Trick. This changes the hierarchy of suits, so now the lowest strength card wins instead of the highest. Player C (Hermit) draws one card from the deck, discards one card, and then plays Red 9 since they do not have a Black card. Player D (Berserker) has the Black 10 in hand and normally must play that. However, they also have the White Flag card in hand which can be played at any time, so they choose to play that instead. Player D (Berserker) wins the trick and will lead the next trick, since they played the lowest strength card during the Revolt Trick.

Player A: 1 trick

Player B: 0 tricks

Player C: 0 tricks

Player D: 2 tricks



Trick 4

Trick 4: Player D (Berserker) plays Black 10, therefore, Black is the lead suit. Player A (King) does not have any Black cards and can play any card. They choose to play the King Rare card. Player B (Resistance) plays Black 6, and Player C (Hermit) draws one card from the deck, discards one card, and then plays Green 1 since they do not have a Black card. Player A (King) played the highest strength card, because a Rare card is stronger than all number cards, so they win the trick and will lead the next trick.

Player A: 2 tricks

Player B: 0 tricks

Player C: 0 tricks

Player D: 2 tricks



Trick 5

Trick 5: Player A (King) plays Red 4, therefore, Red is the lead suit. Player B (Resistance) plays Red 3, Player C (Hermit) draws one card from the deck, discards one card, and then plays Red 5, and Player D (Berserker) plays the Berserker card. The Berserker card is stronger than all other playing cards, but will lose to the Red 1, Blue 1, Green 1, and Black 1. However, no 1s were played into the trick. Therefore, Player D (Berserker) played the highest strength card and wins the last trick of the round.

Player A: 2 tricks

Player B: 0 tricks

Player C: 0 tricks

Player D: 3 tricks



After all 5 tricks, players check to see if their character's win condition was met. The King needed to win all 5 tricks, which was not met. The Resistance needed to win the Revolt trick with a Black card during the round, which was not met. The Hermit needed to win all 5 tricks, which was not met. The Berserker's win condition of winning 0 tricks does not activate until Round 3, so it could not have been met this round.

Since none of the character's win condition were met, players will gain crowns. The Berserker won the most tricks in the round, so they gain the gold crown. The Resistance and the Hermit won 0 tricks in the round, so they both gain a black crown.

Next, players will gain points based on what is showing on their character card. The King won 2 tricks and gets 50 points. The Resistance only scores points if they win the Revolt trick during the round, which they did not do, so they get 0 points. The Hermit won 0 tricks and gets 50 points. Finally, the Berserker won 3 tricks and gets 50 points.

Lastly, players will check to see if they have 2 gold crowns or 3 black crowns, which no one has, so the game continues.

HOW TO PLAY: USING ADDITIONAL CHARACTERS

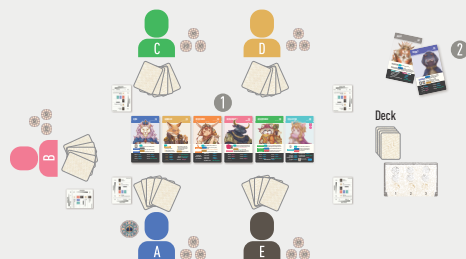


Once you are familiar with the Basic Characters, you can start to add the Advanced Characters into your games! If this is your first time playing with them, it is recommended to add them into your games in this order: Adventurer, Collector, Ruler.

Differences When Playing With Additional Characters

If you are using 6 or more characters in a game, then during 'Game Preparation: Step 3,' you will randomly place characters, equal to the number of players + 1. If there are any remaining characters, set them aside for now. After character selection, there will be 1 character not selected. Set it aside with any characters that were set aside earlier. In the next round, during 'Step 2: Select A Character,' all characters that were set aside in the previous round must be placed first. Then, shuffle all characters that were used in the previous round and place them out, one at a time, until you have reached players + 1.

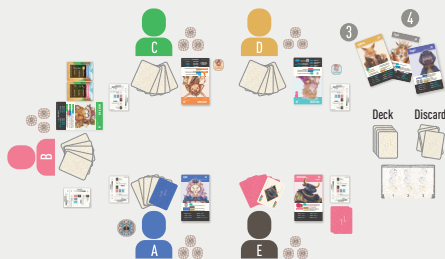
Example: 5 player game using 8 characters:



Shuffle all 8 characters and place 6 of them (5 players + 1), in the middle of the table, face up ①. Set the remaining 2 characters aside for now ②.

After all 5 players have selected a character, set aside the remaining unselected character next to the other 2 characters that were set aside earlier ③.

In the next round, when placing 6 new characters, the 3 characters that are set aside earlier must be included first ④. Then take the 5 characters that were used during the previous round, shuffle them, and place 3 more to have a total of 6. Set aside the 2 remaining characters.



HOW TO PLAY: ADVANCED CHARACTERS - ADVENTURER

DIFFICULT



Initial Equipment During 'Step 3: Set Up Characters,' you **must** place 1 **blue** and 1 **red** initial item card, of your choice, on the initial equipment cards. Afterwards, shuffle the 9 regular item cards, along with the 4 unselected initial item cards, and place them next to your character, face down, to create the item card deck.

Note: While an item is on an equipment card, it is considered to be an available item. Available items are public information and should be visible to all players.

Initial blue items - Map of Destiny, Invisibility Potion, Timid Boots **Initial red items** - Miracle Sword, Ruler's Wand, Berserker's Axe

Regular items - Hermit's Book of Secrets, White Orb, Proactive Wing, Dragon Doll, Fairy Mischief, Castle Visit, Gold, Crystal, Rock Crystal



You select the Adventurer and choose the **Map of Destiny** and the **Miracle Sword** as your initial items ①. Next, you take the 4 unselected initial items and shuffle them together with the 9 regular items creating the item deck ②. Finally, you place the item deck next to your character card and initial equipment cards ③.

Using Items

On your turn, during 'Step 4: Play Tricks,' you **may** use 1 available item before playing a card into the trick. When using an item, place it in front of the equipment card it was on and trigger the item effects. After using the item, place it next to the item card deck, face up, creating the item discard pile. Then draw a new item card from the item card deck, and place it on top of the equipment card, face up. You **cannot** discard an available item without using it first. You **can only use 1 item per trick**.

Note: Only the Adventurer can use item cards. Item card effects only apply to the Adventurer and no other player.



Level Up

When you win a trick, collect all of the playing cards used in the trick and place them in a face up pile next to the initial equipment cards. This pile becomes a new equipment card, known as an 'extra equipment card,' capable of holding a new item card. Immediately draw an item card from the item card deck and place it on the extra equipment card.

Note: You may not move available item cards onto different equipment cards. Once an item card is placed on an equipment card, it must stay on that card until it is used. This is important for scoring purposes!



HOW TO PLAY: ADVANCED CHARACTERS - ADVENTURER'S INITIAL ITEMS



Map of Destiny



Discard any number of playing cards from your hand and draw that many back from the draw deck.

Example: Discard 3 cards and draw 3 cards.

Miracle Sword



You will change the value on a number card you play this trick by exactly ± 5 . The lowest value is 1, the highest 9.

Note: You announce this when you play the card.
Note: Cannot be used on a Rare or White Flag card.

Example: Blue 8 was led. You play the Blue 5, and when played, you can change it to a Blue 1 or Blue 9.

Invisibility Potion



Play your card face down this trick. You must follow the lead color, if possible. Flip your card face up after all players have played their card.

Note: You may not use this item when leading, except in a 2-player game.

Example: Black 10 was led. You play the Black 1 face down. After everyone plays their card this trick, flip your card face up.

Ruler's Wand



Note: You may use this item when leading.
Note: Cannot be used on a Rare or White Flag card.

Example: Blue 8 was led. You have a Blue 4 in your hand, but you play the Red 9 instead. Your Red 9 becomes a Blue 9.

Timid Boots



You will play your card last this trick. If you use this when leading, the next player becomes the lead player.

Example: White Flag was led. You are next, but Timid Boots allows you to skip your turn. The Hermit and Gambler play their cards next. Finally, you play your card last.

Berserker's Axe



Note: Cannot be used on a Rare or White Flag card.

Example: Green 9 was led. You play the Green 2 which changes to a Green 10. However, the King played the Green 1 which is stronger than the Green 10 and wins the trick.

HOW TO PLAY: ADVANCED CHARACTERS - ADVENTURER'S REGULAR ITEMS



Hermit's Secret Book



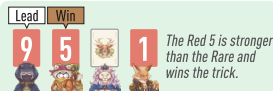
Before playing a card, draw 1 card from the draw deck and then discard any 1 card from your hand.

Example: Draw the Red 8 and discard the Blue 6.

Dragon Doll



Note: Can be used even if no Rares are played



Castle Visit



Example: You have 3 available items: Castle Visit, Timid Boots, and White Orb. You use the Castle Visit item to discard the other 2 and draw 3 new items: Gold, Dragon Doll, and Crystal.

White Orb



The card you play becomes a White Flag. Since you will be playing a White Flag you can play any card from your hand, ignoring the must follow rule.

Example: Red 3 was led. You have the Red 9 in hand, but choose to play the Green 5 and turn it into a White Flag.

Fairy Mischief



Note: Cannot be used in the 5th trick.

Example: 2nd trick - you reveal your hand: Red 3, Red 5, Blue 8, and a Rare. 3rd trick - you use Map of Destiny to discard the Red 3, Red 5, and Blue 8 and draw 3 new cards. The new cards are kept hidden from the other players.

Crystal



Note: This item cannot be used.

Example: The Crystal is on the initial blue item equipment card, so at the end of the round you will gain 20 points.

Proactive Wing



Reminder: As with all Adventurer items, this ONLY applies to your card!



Gold



Rock Crystal



Note: This item cannot be used.

Example: The Rock Crystal is on an extra equipment card, so at the end of the round you will gain 50 points.

Acquiring Points

After all 5 tricks, you will gain points for each trick you won. Additionally, you will gain or lose points according to the available items you have unused on your initial and extra equipment cards.

Example: You won 2 tricks during the round. On your 2 initial equipment cards you have the Rock Crystal and Gold items and on your 2 extra equipment cards you have the Crystal and Fairy Mischief items.



Won 2 tricks: +20 points
Rock Crystal on initial equipment card: +30 points
Gold on initial equipment card: +10 points
Crystal on extra equipment card: +30 points
Fairy Mischief on extra equipment card: -30 points

Total: 60 points

HOW TO PLAY: ADVANCED CHARACTERS - COLLECTOR

MODERATE



Reservation

During 'Step 3: Set Up Characters,' place the Reserve Token next to your character card. On your turn, during 'Step 4: Play Tricks,' after playing a card you may reserve a card by placing the Reserve Token on any playing card already in the trick. When another player wins the trick, you only collect the card you have reserved. If you win the trick, you collect all played cards instead. Place all collected cards face down in front of you. After the trick, place the Reserve Token next to your character card again, so that it is available for use in the next trick.

Note: You may look at your collected cards at any point during the round, but be sure to keep them hidden from the other players.

Regardless of the number of tricks won, the Collector cannot gain a gold or black crown!

The Collector can stop another player from gaining a crown, even if they cannot gain it themselves.

So, be sure to keep track of the number of tricks you have won if you ever want look at your collected cards.



1

Lead Win

Your Card

Trick 1: After you play the Blue 9, you are able to reserve the Blue 7, Blue 5, or Blue 9. You choose to reserve the Blue 7. The Rare that is played after wins the trick, so you only collect the Blue 7 ①.

2

Lead Win

Your Card

Trick 2: After you play the Black 1, you are able to reserve the Black 10, White Flag, Black 2, or Black 1. However, you really do not need to reserve any card as you will collect all four cards for winning the trick ②.

3

Lead Win

Your Card

Trick 3: After you play the Red 7, you are only able to reserve the Red 7. You choose to reserve the Red 7. The other three cards are played and the Black 8 wins the trick, so you only collect the Red 7 ③.

Set Collection

After all 5 tricks, you will gain points by making combinations with the cards you collected.

When making combinations keep these 5 things in mind:

- 1) You can only make up to 3 combinations.
- 2) Rare cards are wild and can be used as any number card.
Only one Rare card can be used in each combination.
- 3) White Flags and the Berserker card **cannot** be used in any combination.
- 4) You **cannot** use the same card in more than one combination.
- 5) For every two cards that are not used in a combination, you will lose 10 points.

The possible combinations you can make:

	3 Flush: 3 cards of the same color +20 points		4 of a Kind: 4 cards of the same number +80 points
	3 Straight: 3 cards of consecutive numbers +30 points		5 Straight Flush: 5 cards of consecutive numbers with the same color +100 points
	3 of a Kind: 3 cards of the same number +40 points		9 Straight Flush: 9 cards of consecutive numbers with the same color Win the game!
	3 Straight Flush: 3 cards of consecutive numbers with the same color +50 points		

HOW TO PLAY: ADVANCED CHARACTERS - RULER

DIFFICULT



Giving Tasks

During 'Step 3: Set Up Characters,' after all players have finished setting up their characters, you must give each other player 1 task card. There are two types of task cards (Normal and Hard).

Normal tasks - Do not take a Red, Do not take a Blue, Do not take a Green Hard tasks - Take a Red, Take a Blue, Take a Green

- If a player completes their task by the end of the round, they will gain points as shown on their task card. Additionally, when playing with 3-5 players, the Ruler will also gain points from every completed task.
- If a player does not complete their task by the end of the round, they will lose points as shown on their task card. However, the Ruler will not lose any points from uncompleted tasks.
- After a player completes a hard task during the round, flip the task card face down to show it has been completed. Normal tasks cannot be completed until after all 5 tricks are resolved.

1

As the Ruler, you give:

- The King the 'Take a Blue' task,
- The Hermit the 'Do not take a Red' task
- The Collector the 'Take a Red' task ①

2

By the end of the round:

- The King took a Blue card, so they gain 20 points and you gain 20 points.
- The Hermit did not take a Red card, so they gain 10 points and you gain 10 points.
- The Collector did not take a Red card, so only they lose 10 points ②.

The Ruler can gain additional points:

- All tasks are completed:
+10 points
- Take a Black card in any trick:
+10 points
- Only win 1 trick in the round:
+20 points
- Win 2 or more tricks that do not have Red, Blue, and Green cards:
Win the game!

Rule Avoidance

During 'Step 3: Set Up Characters,' place the 4 Lead Tokens next to your character card. On your turn, during 'Step 4: Play Tricks,' you may play any card from hand, initially ignoring the must follow rule. If you do, you must place the Lead Token of the matching lead suit on the card you just played. On the other hand, if you cannot follow the lead suit, you may choose to place the Lead Token or not. After the trick, place the Lead Token next to your character card again, so that it is available for use in the next trick.

Note: The Lead Token is simply there to remind players the card you played is now matching the lead suit.

Example 1: The Black 9 was led. Normally, you would have to play the Black 1. However, the Ruler can initially ignore the must follow rule and play a different card. So you decide to play the Blue 8. Because you ignored the must follow rule, you must place the Black Lead Token on the Blue 8, changing it to a Black 8.

Example 2: The Blue 5 was led. You do not have a Blue card in hand, so you can play any card you want. Since you are not initially ignoring the must follow rule, you can decide if you want to place the Blue Lead Token on the card you play. You choose to play the Black 1 and decide not place the Blue Lead Token, so your card stays as a Black 1.

■ HOW TO PLAY: GAME PREPARATION (2 PLAYERS BASIC)

The following rules are used when playing with 2 players.



For your first few games, it is recommended to keep the 6 Game Aid cards nearby. These cards help outline the steps for Game Preparation, Round 1-4 gameplay, Round 5 gameplay, the character selection process for each round, and the order of character priority.

1 Give each player 30 points. Place the remaining point tokens near the middle of the table, creating the common supply.

2 Choose a lead player and give them the lead player token and the 5 gold crowns. Give the other player the 5 black crowns.

The last person to win a game of TRICKTAKERS will be the lead player, otherwise choose randomly.

3 Place the 5 basic character (King, Gambler, Resistance, Hermit, and Berserker) cards face up near the middle of the table. Place each mini character card on top of the appropriate character.

For your first few games, it is recommended to use these 5 basic characters. After you are comfortable with the basic characters, you may use any of the 3 advanced characters instead (explained in more detail on pages 22-27).

4 Shuffle all 40 playing cards and place them face down near the character cards, creating the draw deck.

PGC Variant: Remove the 7, 8, and 9 in all four suits (12 cards in total). This means the deck will only be 28 cards (1-6 in all four suits, 2 Rares, and 2 White Flags).

5 Give each player 1 Suit Hierarchy card, with the white border side face up.

! Important character differences when playing with 2 players:

- All characters lose their "win the game" condition, except for the Berserker. The Berserker can win the game in the last round (Round 5) if they win 0 tricks or 1 trick.
- The King loses "King's Privilege".
- The Resistance can use their Revolt Token twice in a round, instead of once. After the first use, place the token next to your character card so it can be used again. After the second use, set the token aside.
- The Ruler gives the other player 2 tasks instead of 1.
- The Ruler **does not** gain points from any completed tasks.

■ HOW TO PLAY: ROUNDS 1-5 (2 PLAYERS BASIC)



1 Deal Playing Cards

Deal 5 cards to each player from the draw deck. Players should look at the cards that are dealt to them, but make sure to keep them hidden from the other players. At the beginning of Rounds 2-5, be sure to reshuffle the 40 playing cards before dealing.

2 Select a Character

In Rounds 1 and 3, the player with the gold crowns will select a character first. In Rounds 2 and 4, the player with the black crowns will select a character first. When selecting a character, place your crown above the character card and take the mini character card, placing it face up in front of yourself. **Be sure to leave any previously placed crowns and the bigger character card where they are!** Once a character is selected, the other player cannot select the same character that round.

Note: Unlike the 3-5 player rules, players will not gain crowns throughout the game. In 2 player games, the crowns are simply used to track which character you have selected. You may only select a specific character once in the entire game (5 rounds).

3 Set Up Characters

Setting up each character is completed in character priority order, highest first (1A, 2A, 3A...). However, to help speed up the process, players may agree to do this step simultaneously. Each character is explained in more detail on pages 12-27.

4 Play Tricks

Play 5 tricks as described on pages 6-7. In Rounds 1-4, the player who selected a character first in the round will lead the first trick. In Round 5, the player with the fewest points will determine who leads the first trick.

5 Gain Points

All players will gain (or lose) points according to the conditions written on their mini character card. If this is the end of Round 1-4, repeat steps 1-5. If this is the end of Round 5, proceed to step 6.

Note: Players cannot have less than 0 points. If you were to lose points and go below 0, stop at 0 points instead.

6 Calculate Points and Determine Final Winner

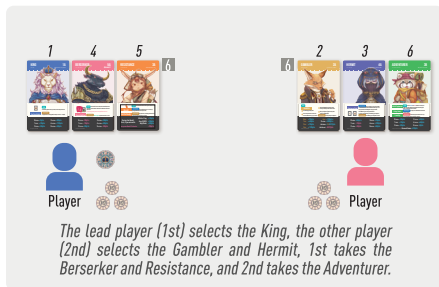
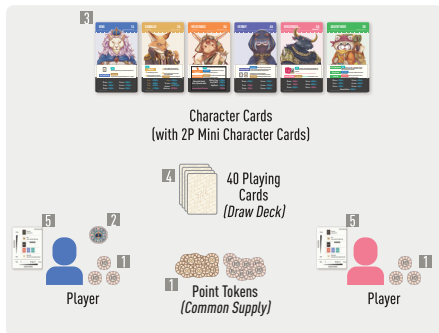
Both players will calculate the number of points they have and the player with the most points wins! If there is a tie, the player with the higher priority character in Round 5 wins.



■ HOW TO PLAY: GAME PREPARATION (2 PLAYERS ADVANCED)



The following rules are used when playing with 2 players and using additional characters.



! Important character differences when playing with 2 players:
- The Ruler gives the other player 2 tasks instead of 1.

- 1 Give each player 30 points. Place the remaining point tokens near the middle of the table, creating the common supply.
- 2 Choose a lead player and give them the lead player token. Be sure to return the gold and black crowns to the box as you will not need them for this game.
The last person to win a game of TRICKTAKERS will be the lead player, otherwise choose randomly.
- 3 Decide whether you want to play with exactly 6 or exactly 8 characters. When playing with 6 characters, it is recommended to use the King, Gambler, Resistance, Hermit, Berserker, and Adventurer. However, you can use any combination you would like. After determining your characters, place them face up near the middle of the table. Place each mini character card on top of the appropriate character.

- 4 Shuffle all 40 playing cards and place them face down near the character cards, creating the draw deck.
! PGC Variant: Remove the 7-9 in all four suits.
- 5 Give each player 1 Suit Hierarchy card, with the white border side face up.
- 6 Starting with the lead player, players will take turns selecting 3 or 4 characters each (3 characters when using 6 characters total or 4 characters when using 8 characters total).
When playing with 6 Characters the selection order will be:
1st → 2nd → 2nd → 1st → 1st → 2nd
When playing with 8 Characters the selection order will be:
1st → 2nd → 2nd → 1st → 1st → 2nd → 2nd → 1st

■ HOW TO PLAY: ROUNDS 1-3(4) (2 PLAYERS ADVANCED)



1 Deal Playing Cards

Deal 5 cards to each player from the draw deck. Players should look at the cards that are dealt to them, but make sure to keep them hidden from the other players. At the beginning of Rounds 2-4, be sure to reshuffle the 40 playing cards before dealing.

2 Select a Character

Both players will simultaneously select 1 of their characters to use for that round and place it face up in front of themselves. **Be sure to place the matching mini character card on top of the bigger character card!** Each character can only be used once per game. At the end of the round, place the characters that were used that round back in the box.

3 Set Up Characters

Setting up each character is completed in character priority order, highest first (1A, 2A, 3A...). However, to help speed up the process, players may agree to do this step simultaneously. Each character is explained in more detail on pages 12-27.

4 Play Tricks

Play 5 tricks as described on pages 6-7. For Rounds 1-4, the player who selected a character with a higher priority will be the lead player for the first trick.

5 Gain Points

All players will gain (or lose) points according to the conditions written on their character card. If this is the end of Round 1 or 2, repeat steps 1-5. If this is the end of Round 3 (or 4 with 8 characters), proceed to step 6.

Note: Players cannot have less than 0 points. If you were to lose points and go below 0, stop at 0 points instead.

6 Calculate Points and Determine Final Winner

Both players will calculate the number of points they have and the player with the most points wins! If there is a tie, the player with the higher priority character in the final round wins.



■ CHARACTER STRATEGY



The more tricks you win, the higher your score will be!

EASY

The extra Rare card makes it easier for you to win tricks. You want to win as many tricks as possible to get a lot of points and the gold crown. You should consider taking the King when you have a strong hand. Also, you earn first priority to select a character for the next round. If you gained a gold crown in the previous round as the King, it may be a good idea to choose a character that has an easier time winning tricks, such as the Berserker or Adventurer, aiming for the second gold crown.



You want to aim for getting the highest score!

MODERATE

If you don't like your initial hand, the Gambler may be a good choice. This is because you can exchange your cards before playing tricks in each round. The more cards you exchange, the more information you can get about what is not in the other player's hands. If you bid for 1 or 2 trick wins, bet high and win big! If you bid for 2 or 3 trick wins, you may not want to bet.



Try to lose 4 tricks and then win big during the Revolt!

MODERATE

The Revolt is a powerful ability that changes the card strength hierarchy. The other players need to be careful about leading with the Black suit, as you win the game when you win the Revolt Trick with a Black card. The Revolt is declared as you play your card, so it is usually a good idea to declare it when you are the last to play a card in the trick. Be sure to only win the Revolt Trick to be eligible for a black crown.



Normally you want 0 tricks to gain a lot of points and a black crown!

EASY

Before your play, you can draw a card, and discard a card. There is a high chance you will be able to avoid the must follow rules. Try your best to lose all the tricks and get 50 points and a black crown. However, the other players will likely anticipate this, so you can surprise them by winning 3+ tricks if your hand is strong. If you plan on winning tricks, be sure to win with a White Flag when there is a Rare card in play.



You want to focus on gaining the gold crown rather than points!

MODERATE

The Berserker's exclusive deck is very strong. But watch out—other players know what cards are in the Berserker deck and can have an idea of what you might play. Since you are weak to the 1s, it helps to check how many '1' cards you have before discarding your hand. You don't get as many points as the King from winning tricks, so it is better for you to be aiming for the gold crown rather than points. Just be careful not to win all 5 tricks or else you will lose points.



Use items to your advantage, some unused items are negative points!

DIFFICULT

Each time you win a trick you will get a new equipment card. So, you should try to win as many tricks as possible from the beginning. However, you may lose points by not using some of your items. What you draw from the item deck will affect the Adventurer's playstyle. You may or may not want to win the 5th trick, because the item you draw could have negative points. If you don't like your initial hand, consider choosing the "Map of Destiny" as your initial blue equipment card and using it in the first trick.



Make sure to win at least 1 trick, and make at least 2 combinations!

MODERATE

You cannot gain gold or black crowns, so getting as high of a score as possible is the main strategy. Since you can stop other players from gaining the gold crown, trying to win as many tricks as possible is a good idea. Getting around 50 points is good, and 80+ is best, so you should aim for combinations around that score. You will always get the card you reserved, so keep that in mind when deciding what combination you are trying to make. Aiming for a "straight flush" can be a good start.



You will want to be familiar with the abilities of every character!

DIFFICULT

How do you distribute the task cards? Typically, you should give the Hard tasks to characters such as the King and Berserker, while giving Normal tasks to the Resistance and Hermit. You can initially ignore the must follow rule and should use that to your advantage in helping other characters complete their tasks or to help you win tricks. Winning 2 tricks without Red, Blue, or Green cards is very difficult, so try to hold back any Black or Rare cards until the moment is right!

MODULAR VARIANTS

COMPONENTS



4 Mini Character Variant Cards



10 Ruler Variant Task Cards

All variants listed below are optional and we recommend only using them after you have played and enjoyed the original version a few times first! All variants are modular and can be mixed and matched as the players see fit. However, be mindful of the appropriate player count for some variants. All players should agree upon the variants selected before the game starts.

RESISTANCE VARIANT (3 PLAYER ONLY)



You no longer **win the game** if you win the Revolt Trick with a black card. Instead, you will gain 100 points and during 'Step 5: Gain Gold Crown' you gain that round's gold crown. You gain the gold crown regardless of who would have been eligible for it. Additionally, you can still gain a black crown if the Revolt Trick is the only trick you win in the round.

COLLECTOR VARIANT (3 PLAYER ONLY)



All gameplay rules are the same, except for 2 changes: 1) You will be eligible for a black crown if you win 0 tricks, and 2) You have different combination options and you win the game if you get a 5 Straight Flush or a 9 Straight.

The possible combinations you can make:

	3 Flush: 3 cards of the same color +20 points		5 Flush: 5 of the same color +90 points
	3 Straight: 3 cards of consecutive numbers +30 points		5 Straight: 5 consecutive numbers +100 points
	3 of a Kind: 3 cards of the same number +40 points		5 Straight Flush: 5 cards of consecutive numbers with the same color <i>Win the game!</i>
	4 Flush: 4 of the same color +50 points		9 Straight: 9 cards of consecutive numbers <i>Win the game!</i>
	4 Straight: 4 consecutive numbers +60 points		
	4 of a Kind: 4 of the same number +80 points		

COLLECTOR VARIANT (4-5 PLAYER ONLY)



All gameplay rules are the same, except for 2 changes: 1) You will be eligible for a black crown if you win 0 tricks, and 2) You have different combination options and you win the game if you get a 9 Straight.

The possible combinations you can make:

	3 Flush: 3 cards of the same color +20 points		5 Flush: 5 of the same color +90 points
	3 Straight: 3 cards of consecutive numbers +30 points		5 Straight: 5 consecutive numbers +100 points
	3 of a Kind: 3 cards of the same number +40 points		5 Straight Flush: 5 cards of consecutive numbers with the same color +120 points
	4 Flush: 4 of the same color +50 points		9 Straight: 9 cards of consecutive numbers <i>Win the game!</i>
	4 Straight: 4 consecutive numbers +60 points		
	4 of a Kind: 4 of the same number +80 points		

RULER VARIANT (3-5 PLAYER ONLY)



All gameplay rules are the same, except for the following changes:

- In 3-player games, the Ruler can give out 1 or 2 task cards to the other players. This means *you can give both players 1 task card, one player 1 task card and the other player 2 task cards, or both players 2 task cards.*

The Ruler can gain additional points:

- All tasks are completed:
+30 points
- Take a Black card in any trick:
+10 points
- Only win 1 trick in the round¹:
+20 points and gain the gold crown
- Only win 1 trick in the round that does not have Red, Blue, and Green cards²:
Win the game!

¹If you only win 1 trick in the round, during 'Step 5: Gain Gold Crown' you gain that round's gold crown. You gain the gold crown regardless of who would have been eligible for it. If you are playing with the 3 player Resistance variant, and both characters are eligible for the gold crown, the Resistance would gain the gold crown since they have higher character priority.

²If you only win 1 trick in the round, but there are Red, Blue, and/or Green cards in the trick, you do not win the game, but you can still gain the gold crown. Additionally, if you win 2 or more tricks in the round, even if there are no Red, Blue, and/or Green cards in all tricks, you do not win the game.

■ MODULAR VARIANTS

RULER VARIANT TASK CARDS (3-5 PLAYER ONLY)



When using the new task cards, you may add them to the existing 6 task cards or replace them completely. There is a new type of task card: **Difficult**, which is worth 30 points if completed.

These tasks are mainly designed to include some variability in the task choices for the Ruler. However, they are also designed to help learn some of the other character's strengths and weaknesses a little quicker. While all variants are only recommended to be used **after** playing the original game multiple times, this variant can be helpful if you have one or more experienced players along with new players at the table. The Ruler tends to be the most difficult character to play since it requires a good understanding of all other characters. Therefore, these tasks should help all players, new or experienced, identify what each character is typically aiming for in the round.

Difficult



Note: "Avoid lead suit all 5 tricks" means, after applying any and all character abilities, if you ever play a card into a trick that matches the color of the lead suit you will fail this task. This also means if you ever lead a trick, you will fail this task, unless you lead with a colorless card.

Example 1: Red 8 was lead. You are the Adventurer and you use the White Orb and play a Red 4. The Red 4 becomes a White Flag, therefore you did not play a Red card and you have not failed this task yet.

Example 2: Red 8 was lead. You are the King and you play a Red 9. You played a Red card which is the lead suit, therefore you have failed this task.

Hard



Normal



YOUR OWN VARIANT (2-5 PLAYER)

Do you have a variant for one of the characters? Maybe the King has two Rare cards, or the Berserker can draw cards from the main deck after it discards in Round 3, or the Hermit can draw and discard 2 cards. We would love to hear about any variants you come up with. You can share them by going to <https://boardgamegeek.com/boardgame/343566/tricktakers/forums> or by using the QR code to the right!

Additionally, if you have any rules questions please use the same link or QR code.



■ THANK YOU!

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We hope you enjoy TRICKTAKERS!



Want to watch a rules video on how to play?

Go to <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=sAybANibUKI> or scan the QR code below



■ CHARACTER ASYMMETRICAL ABILITY RECAPS



- Wants to win as many tricks as possible, wins the game if they win all 5 tricks
- Starts with a Rare Card, no hand manipulation during the round
- Selects a new character (not the King) first next Round, regardless of points or gold crown
- Acquires twice as many points in Round 3



- Wants to win as many tricks as they bid, wins the game if they bid and win 4 tricks or if they win all 5 tricks regardless of their bid
- 0-2x, may discard any number of cards from their hand and draw back an equal number of cards from the draw deck, no hand manipulation during the round
- Acquires 20 points during setup and may bet up to 50 points they will hit their bid, may bet up to 100 points in Round 3



- Typically wants to win 0 or 1 trick (the Revolt Trick) to be eligible to gain a black crown, wins the game if they win the Revolt Trick with a black card
- No hand manipulation during setup or the round
- The Revolt Trick will nullify all card strengthening abilities, such as the Hermit's White Flag card being stronger than a Rare card or the 1s being stronger than the Berserker's 1s or Berserker card
- Each trick won, including the Revolt Trick, during Round 3 is worth 30 points



- Wants to win 0 tricks or 3-5 tricks, wins the game if they win all 5 tricks
- No hand manipulation during setup, but during the round, on their turn and before they play a card to the trick, they may draw a card from the draw deck and discard any card from hand
- Their White Flag cards are stronger than Rare cards in the same trick, they will gain 30 points (100 points during Round 3) if they win a trick this way



- Wants to win 2-4 tricks, wins the game if they win 0 tricks in Round 3
- Replaces entire hand with Berserker card and 4 random cards from the Berserker deck, no hand manipulation during the round
- Berserker card is weaker than all 1s, the 10s are weaker than the 1s of the matching suit
- May spend black crown(s) in Round 3, but cannot discard the Berserker card and only draws from the 2 left over Berserker cards (not the regular draw deck)



- Wants to win as many tricks as possible, wins the game if they win all 5 tricks
- Starts with 2 items, various items will allow for hand manipulation during the round
- May use 1 available item per turn, all available items must be visible for all players to see
- Gains access to more available items after every trick they win
- Gains or loses points equal to all unused available items at the end of the round



- Wants to collect as many cards as possible, wins the game if they collect a '9 card Straight Flush'
- No hand manipulation during setup or the round
- Cannot gain gold or black crowns
- On their turn, after playing, they may place the Reserve Token on any card currently in the trick
- Makes up to 3 combinations at the end of the round, only 1 Rare card per combination, cannot use White Flags or the Berserker card, loses points for every 2 unused cards



- Can win any number of tricks, wins the game if they win 2 or more tricks without taking a red, blue, or green card
- No hand manipulation during setup, but during the round, they may place a Lead Token (that is the same color as the lead suit) on their card making their card match the lead suit
- During setup, they give each other player tasks to complete during the round
- Players must complete their tasks to gain points for themselves and the Ruler, if players fail their task they will lose points (the Ruler does not lose those points)

GAME SUMMARY (3-5 PLAYERS)

1 Deal Playing Cards

5 cards per player

2 Select a Character

Round 1: Clockwise from lead player
Round 2/3: King > No Gold Crown > Gold Crown

3 Set Up Characters

See pages 12-27

4 Play Tricks/Check Character's Win Condition

- Starting from the lead player, and going clockwise, each player plays one card, following the lead suit, if possible.
- The highest strength card in play wins the trick. If it is a Revolt Trick, the lowest strength card in play wins instead.
- Play 5 tricks.
- Check to see if any player completed their character's win condition.

5 Gain Crowns, Points, and Lead Player Token

- The player who won the most tricks will gain the gold crown
- Up to 2 players who won 0 tricks will gain a black crown
- All players will gain or lose points based on their character
- The player with the least amount of points, and no gold crown, gains the Lead Player Token



WINNING CONDITIONS (3-5 PLAYERS)

1 Character's Win Condition

2 Have 2 Gold Crowns

3 Have 3 Black Crowns

4 Have The Most Points

If no player has fulfilled **1**, **2**, or **3** after 3 rounds, the player with the most points wins the game.

If multiple winning conditions are met at in the same round, the earlier condition wins (**1** > **2** > **3** > **4**).

If multiple players have accomplished the same winning condition at the same time, the player who has the higher priority character wins.